

Terminology: Leadership

Term	Definition	Example / Threshold
Emotional Intelligence	Ability to manage one's own emotions and understand others'.	Key trait in strong leaders.
Change Management	Structured approach to shifting individuals/teams to a desired future.	M&A integration, digital transformation.
Culture Fit	Alignment between individual and company values.	Hiring for collaboration in a teamwork-heavy company.
Stakeholder Management	Managing relationships with people impacted by business decisions.	Engaging local community in expansion project.
Servant Leadership	Leadership focused on serving others' growth.	Empowering teams and removing roadblocks.
Delegation	Assigning responsibility to others.	CEO delegating operations to COO.
Incentive Alignment	Ensuring employee interests align with business goals.	Equity for startup employees.

Communicating With Others

Technique	Why It Works	Example Phrase	Formal Title	Origin / Source
Be comfortable with silence	let others fill space, often revealing more		Power of Silence	Chris Voss, Never Split the Difference (2016)
Pause before responding	creates a sense of thoughtfulness, perceived intelligence		Processing Pause	Harvard Business Review
Let the other person talk	people value being heard; boosts their self-perception.		Self-Expression Effect	Dale Carnegie How to Win Friends and Influence People
Talk about the other's interests/desires	increases engagement and relevance	"He loves design — let's frame it that way."	Endowment Effect	
Ask for small favors in moderation	leads to bigger compliance, increases their liking of you	"Would you mind helping me with this?"	Ben Franklin Effect, Foot-In-the-Door	Franklin anecdote; confirmed by Jecker & Landy, 1969
Make them feel as if it is their idea	people are more committed to ideas they believe are theirs	"What do you think would work best? Your input would make this better"	IKEA Effect	Norton, Mochon & Ariely, 2012
Give suggestions, not orders	Increases compliance by supporting autonomy.	"You might try..." / "Would it make sense to...?"	Choice Architecture	Dale Carnegie How to Win Friends and Influence People
Be specific in your praise	makes praises feel genuine and reinforces behavior.	"You handled that client call with real calm under pressure."	Operant Conditioning	Dale Carnegie How to Win Friends and Influence People

Communicating About Yourself

Avoid hedging language	I think → I recommend Maybe we should → I see two options That's a fair question.
When challenged/disagreed on	That's a fair question.
When you don't know	Based on what I know... I don't have that yet, but I'll get it by [time]
	I want to give you a thoughtful answer, can I follow-up?
	Let me go back and think about it for a moment.
Communicating ideas	Lead with the conclusion, then explain second Talk within the first five minutes of a meeting to signal confidence

Improving Yourself

- Traditional routes are very valuable in that you can learn from very high-quality people
 - Reading financial statements is also a very good skill
 - Persistence is key when you have no connections
 - Learning fast has more importance than initial knowledge, especially in a volatile environment
 - If it looks seemingly like a crowded market, use real-life experience to see niche/gap
 - Finding network isn't really that's that goal but just having friends that do cool stuff later on
 - Optimize for your current situation, not planning ahead and assuming that will not need to change
- if you become an authority figure on your matter of business, it increases trust in consumers

Behavior Phenomenons

people act consistently with past choices	"You've already started this — want to keep going?"	Commitment & Consistency	Cialdini, Influence (1984)
people infer attitudes from their behavior		Self-Perception Theory	Bem, 1972
people follow group behavior	"Others in your role found this helpful."	Social Proof	Cialdini, Influence (1984)
people trust credible sources	"This technique is recommended by top psychologists."	Authority Bias	Milgram Experiment (1963); Cialdini
people value scarcity, it is desirable to have	"Only 2 left in stock."	Scarcity Principle	Cialdini, Influence (1984)
people view ideas as more common after exposure	"Once you notice it, you see it everywhere."	Frequency Illusion	Baader-Meinhof Phenomenon
people feel pressured to repay favors	"Let me do this for you."	Reciprocity Norm	Gouldner, 1960
people evaluate options relatively	"Compared to the premium version, this is a deal."	Contrast Bias	Tversky & Kahneman, 1974

Behavior Biases and Heuristics

Cognitive Bias	the tendency to search for, interpret, favor and recall information in a way that confirms or supports one's prior beliefs or values.
Hindsight Bias	people to perceive past events as having been more predictable than they were.
Survivorship Bias	researchers focus on individuals, groups, or cases that have passed some sort of selection process while ignoring those who did not
Exponential Growth Bias	Many people consistently underestimate how fast the value increases
Availability Bias	mental shortcut that relies on immediate examples that come to a given person's mind when evaluating a specific topic; can lead us to believe information that is untrue or make decisions without all the facts.
Incentive Bias	the tendency for people to act in ways that align with their incentives, rewards, or self-interest, even if those actions are not in their best interest or the best interest of others; wrong incentives can have second-order effects
Self-Serving Bias	any cognitive or perceptual process that is distorted by the need to maintain and enhance self-esteem
Framing Effect	Individuals make different decisions based on how information is presented, even if the underlying information is identical